



PennSync

BY CAREMETRIC

User Manual

For clinical & office staff — nurses, social workers, spiritual care, therapists, aides, and administrative team members

[Home Health](#)[Hospice](#)[Clinical & Office Staff](#)[AI-Assisted Documentation](#)

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Everything you need to work confidently in PennSync, from your first sign-in to advanced AI documentation.

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1 Welcome to PennSync

PennSync by CareMetric is an intelligent, AI-powered documentation and analytics platform built specifically for home health and hospice agencies. It brings your patients, visits, clinical notes, communication, compliance, and learning into one place — so you can spend less time on paperwork and more time on care.

OVERVIEW

What PennSync is

PennSync combines everyday clinical workflows with AI assistance that helps you write faster, more compliant documentation. Behind the scenes it keeps your notes aligned with Medicare requirements, watches for patients at risk, and keeps your whole team in sync.

AI-assisted documentation

Turn a few observations — typed or spoken — into a complete, skilled, Medicare-compliant note.

One connected record

Patients, visits, vitals, documents, OASIS, and messages all live on a single Patient 360 record.

Built-in compliance

Real-time checks flag documentation gaps before they become audit findings.

Work anywhere

Mobile-friendly screens let you document a visit from a phone or tablet at the point of care.

AUDIENCE

Who this manual is for

This guide is for everyone who delivers or supports patient care in PennSync — both **clinical** and **non-clinical (office)** team members:

- **Clinical staff** — registered nurses and LPNs, social workers, spiritual care providers and chaplains, and therapists (PT / OT / ST).
- **Field & support staff** — home health aides and CNAs.
- **Office & administrative staff** — schedulers, intake and referral coordinators, records and documentation clerks, billing/office coordinators, and front-office team members.

Wherever a feature is used differently for Home Health versus Hospice, we call it out.



A note on roles

Some back-office and administrative screens (Referrals, Documents & E-Signing, Incident Review, Admin Console, Reports & Analytics, Compliance Center) require administrator access. If you do not see a feature in your sidebar, your role may not include it — that is expected, not an error. Office staff who need these tools should ask their facility administrator about access.

GETTING THE MOST FROM IT

How to use this manual

- Use the **Contents** page to jump straight to a task.
- Look for **"Go to"** chips like the one below — they show the exact path through the app.
- Watch for the callout boxes: **Tips** save you time, **Important** notes prevent mistakes, and **Best practice** boxes reflect how top-performing clinicians work.
- **Figures** are simplified, labeled illustrations of the PennSync interface used to walk you through a screen; your live screens show real patient data and full detail.

GO TO

Sidebar



Overview



Dashboard

2

Feature Overview

A quick map of everything PennSync does. Each feature below is covered step by step later in this manual.

PATIENT CARE

Care & assessments

Feature	What it does	Find it under
Dashboard	Your daily home base — today's visits, AI-note and time-saved stats, real-time patient alerts, high-risk and hospitalization-risk monitors, pending referrals, announcements, and one-tap quick actions. A Smart Route Optimizer sequences your day's visits.	Overview
Patients	Your census with fuzzy search (name, MRN, phone, diagnosis) and filters for status, diagnosis, age, last visit, and insurance. Add patients, sort, favorite, and act in bulk.	Patient Care ► Patients
Patient 360 record	One connected record per patient: overview and health history, vitals-trend charts, visits, documents, proactive tasks, and AI tools (risk, deterioration, history summary, compliance).	Patients ► (select) ► Patient Details
Patient Alerts	A dedicated view of every clinical, risk, and deterioration alert for your patients — review, prioritize, and acknowledge.	Patient Care ► Patients ► Patient Alerts
OASIS Center	Complete OASIS-E with AI pre-fill and compliance hints — including pre-filling items from a pasted clinical note (with your attestation) — then analyze, review/approve, and validate, all as tabs of one hub.	Patient Care ► OASIS Center
Incidents	Report safety events (falls, medication errors, injuries) with event type, severity, and AI severity scoring; automatic state-reportable detection; track each report to resolution.	Patient Care ► Incidents
Patient Education	Generate personalized, plain-language handouts for common conditions, tuned to the patient's history and reading level; email or print; document teach-back.	Patient Care ► Patient Education

DOCUMENTATION

Charting a visit

Feature	What it does	Find it under
Clinical Notes	The documentation hub for every visit — a clear choice between Smart Note and Visit Scribe, with structured vitals capture and automatic visit + compliance records.	Documentation ► Clinical Notes
Smart Note	Type a few rough observations; AI checks Home Health / Hospice compliance and rewrites them into a complete, skilled note with medical-necessity and homebound language.	Clinical Notes ► Smart Note
Visit Scribe	Document by voice — record or upload audio, or dictate live. AI transcribes and runs the same compliance review and polishing as a typed note.	Clinical Notes ► Visit Scribe
Quick Phrases	Type / (or a saved .shortcut) in a note to expand a stored phrase — including phrases bound to a specific patient — into full, compliant text.	Clinical Notes ► Smart Note
Facility Requirements	A live checklist of your agency’s documentation rules (e.g. SpO ₂ for oxygen patients) that checks off as you type.	Clinical Notes ► Smart Note

COMMUNICATION

Reaching your team & patients

Feature	What it does	Find it under
Messages	Secure internal messaging with Urgent / High / Normal priorities, threading, and patient context for clean handoffs.	Communication ► Messages
Phone Center	Calls and texts through a masked work number (your personal cell stays private): Texts, Recents, Callbacks queue, Scheduled texts, and Duty Status.	Communication ► Phone Center
Fax	Send a fax from your camera, an uploaded file, or a template — with an AI cover page, batch sending, contacts, and delivery tracking.	Communication ► Fax
Providers	A searchable directory of physicians and provider offices with phone, fax, email, address, and specialty.	Communication ► Providers
Telehealth	Schedule and run secure video visits; text the patient a one-tap join link; view vitals live and document from the session.	Communication ► Telehealth

LEARNING & RESOURCES

Growing & referencing

Feature	What it does	Find it under
Learning Center	Courses, learning plans, competencies, certificates, renewals (with calendar export), in-services, annual education, and transcripts.	Learning & Resources ► Learning Center
Nurse Training Hub	Role-specific, AI-personalized nursing training and documentation practice.	Learning Center ► Nurse Training Hub
Reference Libraries	Resource Library (agency guidelines & policies), Clinical Library (disease/medication references), and Medicare Guidelines on demand.	Learning & Resources ► Library

PERSONAL TOOLS

Settings & day-to-day

Feature	What it does	Find it under
Settings	Your profile, care scope (Home Health / Hospice / Both), credentials with expiration reminders, and AI preferences.	Tools ► Settings
Notifications	Choose which alerts you receive (messages, SMS, clinical alerts, approvals) and set quiet hours.	Settings ► Notification Settings
Time Off	Request PTO/sick/vacation and track approvals; managers approve and view a team calendar.	Tools ► Time Off
Timesheets	Submit your biweekly pay-period timesheet — hours, visit points, PTO, mileage — and track it through approval to payroll.	Tools ► Timesheets
On-Call Schedule	View holiday and overnight coverage so you always know who's on (admins edit it).	Tools ► On-Call
Help & User Guides	Quick-start help, searchable FAQs, and downloadable manuals (including this one).	Tools ► Help



For office & administrative staff

Office staff also use back-office tools — **Referrals** (intake with AI extraction), **Documents & E-Signing**, **Incident Review**, and **Template Management**. These require administrator access; ask your facility administrator, and see the *Facility Administrator Manual* for how they work.

3

Getting Started

A quick tour of how to sign in, move around the app, and set yourself up so PennSync works the way you do.

ACCESS

Signing in

1

Open PennSync

Go to your agency's PennSync web address in any modern browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge) on a computer, tablet, or phone.

2

Enter your credentials

On the PennSync sign-in screen, enter the work email and password from your welcome invitation (the eye icon shows or hides your password as you type). First time in, you may be asked to set a new password.

3

Accept the AI responsibility agreement (first sign-in)

Before first use, PennSync asks you to acknowledge that AI-generated content is a starting point that you must review, edit, and approve before it is used or submitted. Check all three statements and choose **I Agree & Continue** — your name, the date, and the agreement version are recorded. You'll only be asked again if the agreement wording changes.

4

Land on your Dashboard

After sign-in you arrive on your Dashboard — your personalized home base for the day. Sign-in returns you to the exact page you were headed to, so links from emails and messages land where they should.

**Add PennSync to your home screen**

On a phone or tablet, use your browser's **Add to Home Screen** option. PennSync installs like an app, opens full-screen and keeps you signed in.

**Forgot your password?**

Choose **Forgot password?** next to the password field — enter your email and PennSync sends you a reset link. You can also ask your facility administrator to trigger a reset. Never share your password — every action in PennSync is recorded under your name for HIPAA accountability.

NAVIGATION

Finding your way around

Every screen shares the same layout. The illustration below maps the four things you'll use most to move around PennSync.

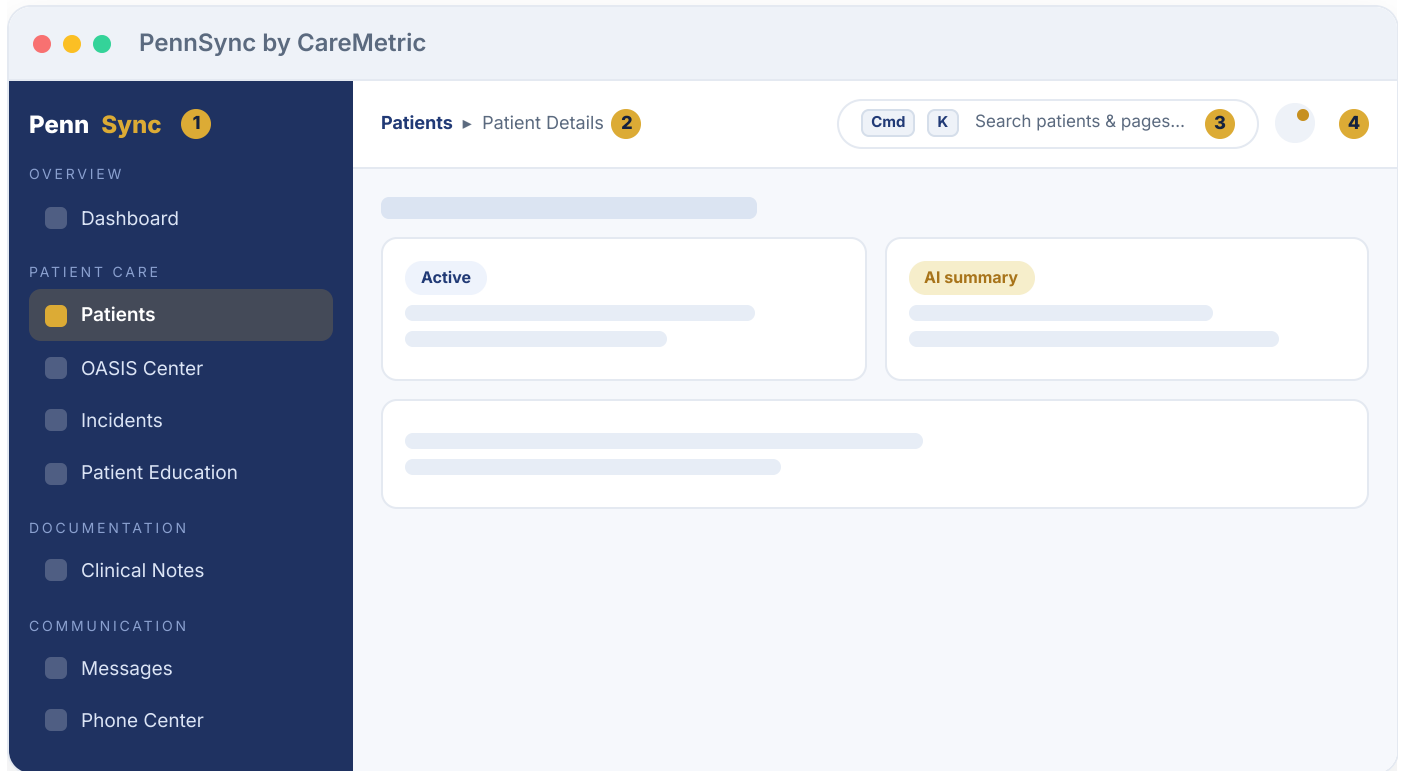


FIGURE The PennSync workspace — the numbered elements are explained in the key below.

- 1 Sidebar** — your features, grouped into Overview, Patient Care, Documentation, Communication, Learning & Resources, and Tools. Tap any item to open it.

2 Breadcrumbs — show where you are (e.g. Patients ► Patient Details); click any crumb to step back.
- 3 Command palette** — press **Cmd** / **Ctrl** + **K** to jump to any page or patient by name.

4 Notifications — the bell shows new alerts, messages, and approvals.



Search beats scrolling

Don't hunt through the sidebar — press **Cmd / Ctrl + K** and type "fax", "oasis", a patient's name, or a task. The command palette only ever shows pages you're allowed to open.

i On a phone

On phones the sidebar collapses to a menu and the most-used shortcuts (including Notes) move to a bottom navigation bar. Pull down on the Dashboard to refresh your visits and alerts.

SET UP

Your profile & care scope

Before your first visit, complete your profile so PennSync tailors itself to you.

GO TO **Sidebar** ▶ **Tools** ▶ **Settings**

1 Open Settings

From the Tools section of the sidebar, choose Settings.

2 Complete your profile

Add your full name, work phone, and credential type (RN, LPN, MSW, chaplain, PT, etc.).

3 Choose your care scope

Select Home Health, Hospice, or Both. Your care scope tailors dashboards, templates, and compliance checks to the right setting.

4 Add your credentials

Record your licenses and certifications with expiration dates so renewal reminders reach you in time.

5 Review AI preferences

On the AI Configuration tab, set how much help you want from AI when writing notes.

i Profile completeness

If key details are missing, PennSync shows a gentle prompt on your Dashboard. Completing your profile improves AI personalization and keeps your credential records audit-ready.

QUICK START

Your first 5 minutes

1 Check your Dashboard

Review today's visits, alerts, and pending tasks.

2 Find or add a patient

Open Patients to search for someone or add a new patient.

3**Document a visit**

Use Clinical Notes — Smart Note (type) or Visit Scribe (speak).

4**Let AI help**

Review the compliant note PennSync drafts from your input.

5**Save & finish**

Save the note, glance at the compliance score, and you're done.

4

Your Dashboard

The Dashboard is your daily command center. It greets you by name, shows what needs attention, and puts your most common tasks one tap away.

GO TO

Sidebar



Overview



Dashboard

AT A GLANCE

What's on your Dashboard

Widget	What it shows
Today's snapshot	Scheduled visits (and how many you've completed), AI-assisted notes created, and the time you've saved over the last 30 days.
Real-time patient alerts	New incidents, clinical changes, and risk alerts for your patients as they happen.
High-risk patients	Patients flagged for possible deterioration or hospitalization so you can prioritize outreach.
Hospitalization risk monitor	AI prediction of which patients are most at risk of an avoidable hospitalization.
Proactive clinical support	AI clinical guidance for the patients you're scheduled to see.
Upcoming telehealth	Your scheduled virtual visits, with quick join links.
Pending referrals	New admissions awaiting action (where your role allows).
Announcements	Messages and updates posted by your administrator.

DO IT FASTER

Quick actions & route planning

Quick-action shortcuts jump you straight into the tasks you do most — **Smart Notes**, **Send Fax**, **Patient Education**, **Visit Scribe**, and **Incidents**.



Plan your day with the Route Optimizer

The **Smart Route Optimizer** sequences today's visits into an efficient driving order, helping you spend less time on the road and more with patients.



Pull to refresh

On a phone, pull down on the Dashboard to refresh your visits, alerts, and announcements.

5

Patients & the Patient Record

Everything about a patient — demographics, visits, vitals, documents, OASIS, alerts, and AI insights — lives on one connected record.

WHO CAN USE THIS

NURSE

FACILITY ADMIN

FIND ANYONE FAST

The patient roster

GO TO

Sidebar

Patient Care

Patients

The Patients page lists your census with summary cards (total active, recently admitted, active count) at the top. To find someone:

Search

Type a name, MRN, phone number, or diagnosis — results filter as you type.

Filter

Narrow by status (active / inactive / discharged), diagnosis, age range, last-visit dates, or insurance type.

Sort

Order by newest, oldest, last visit, or name (A–Z / Z–A).

Swipe (mobile)

Swipe a patient card to reveal quick actions like view or add a visit.

The summary cards at the top are **one-tap filters**: tap **Active** to see only active patients, **New (30 days)** for recent admissions, or **Total** to clear the status filter. Every active filter shows a removable chip above the list, so you can always see — and clear — exactly what is narrowing your results.



Open a patient in one step

Skip the list — press **Cmd / Ctrl + K** and type the patient's name to jump straight to their record.

NEW PATIENT

Adding a patient

1

Start a new patient

On the Patients page, choose Add Patient.

2

Enter demographics

Name, date of birth, contact details, address, and insurance.

3

Add clinical basics

Primary diagnosis, referring provider, and care scope (Home Health or Hospice).

4

Save

The patient is added to your roster and ready for scheduling and documentation.

i

Referrals often create the patient for you

When a patient arrives through the Referral Intake workflow, PennSync can create the record automatically from the referral document — no manual entry needed. See your administrator or the Referrals section.

ONE COMPLETE RECORD**The Patient 360 record**

GO TO

Patients



Select a patient



Patient Details

Opening a patient shows their full record, organized into tabs:

Tab	What you'll find
Overview	Snapshot, quick actions (call, email, refill, discharge), care-team messaging, health history, clinical-events timeline, documents, and an AI-generated patient summary.
AI Tools	Risk stratification, deterioration prediction, history summary, compliance auditor, and proactive OASIS suggestions.
Documents	View, upload, and download the patient's documents and referral paperwork.
Visits	Every past and scheduled visit; start a new visit here.
Tasks	Proactive, AI-generated clinical tasks you can assign and track.

A **vitals trend dashboard** charts vital signs over time, and contact actions let you call the patient through your secure work number, send email, request a refill, start a telehealth visit, or begin a discharge.

**Best practice: work from the record**

Start documentation, education, and communication from inside the patient's record. PennSync then carries their diagnoses, medications, and history into every AI tool — giving you sharper, more personalized results.

STAY AHEAD OF PROBLEMS**Patient alerts & risk**

GO TO

Sidebar ▶

Patient Care ▶

Patients ▶

Patient Alerts

PennSync continuously watches for clinical changes and flags patients at risk. On the Patient Alerts screen you can review every alert, see its severity, and acknowledge it once addressed. High-severity alerts also surface on your Dashboard and inside the patient's record.

6

OASIS Assessments

The OASIS Center is your single home for OASIS-E — completing assessments with AI guidance, then reviewing and validating them for accuracy and compliance.

WHO CAN USE THIS

NURSE

FACILITY ADMIN

GO TO

Sidebar

Patient Care

OASIS Center

GUIDED & AI-ASSISTED

Completing an assessment

1 Open the Assessment tab

The OASIS Center opens on Assessment (Smart OASIS) by default.

2 Select the patient & visit

The assessment links to a specific visit so it lands on the right episode.

3 Work through the guided form

Items branch intelligently based on your answers. AI pre-fills likely responses from the patient's history and offers compliance hints as you go.

4 Review AI suggestions

PennSync highlights clinical pathway suggestions and flags responses that may create compliance or coding risk.

5 Save as draft or submit

Save to finish later, or submit to send the assessment for review and sign-off.



Pre-fill OASIS from a note

At the top of the Assessment tab, open **Pre-fill OASIS from a Note** and paste a recent clinical note. PennSync suggests answers for matching OASIS items, each with a confidence score and the exact sentence from your note it was drawn from. Nothing is written to the assessment until you attest — choose **Attest & apply** per item, or **Attest all ≥85%** for the high-confidence set. Only blank items are filled; your existing answers are never overwritten.



Always confirm AI answers

AI suggestions accelerate OASIS but never replace your clinical judgment. Review every item — especially those that drive the patient's functional score and case mix — before submitting.

EVERYTHING IN ONE PLACE

The OASIS Center

Beyond the assessment itself, the OASIS Center gathers related tools as tabs:

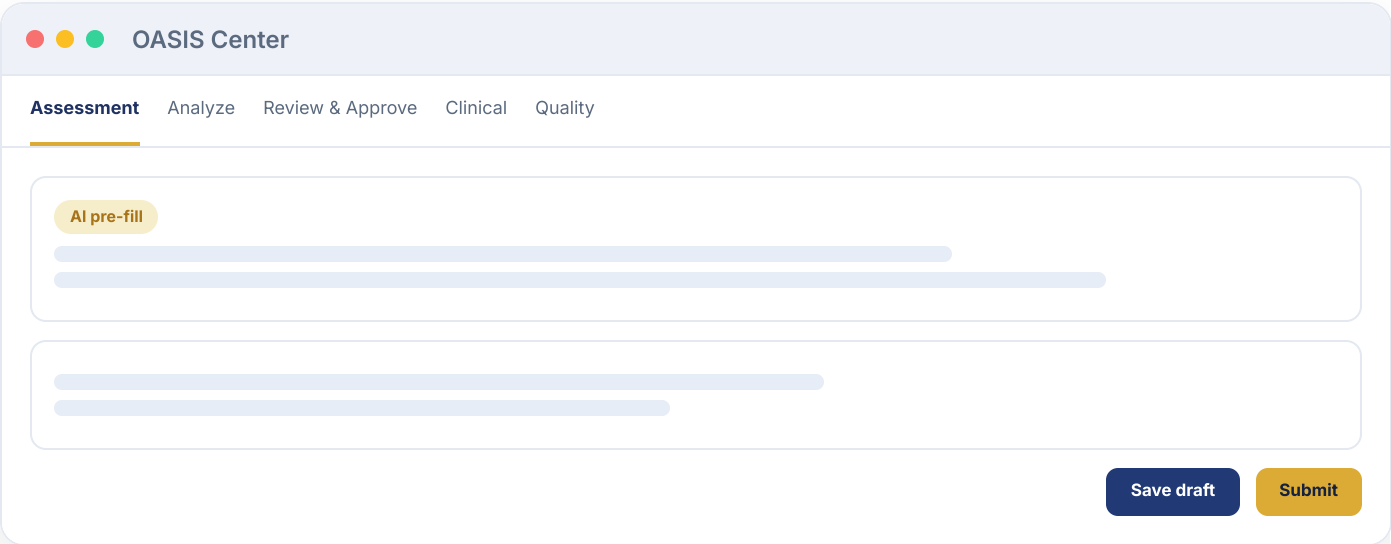


FIGURE The OASIS Center — the Assessment tab is open; the other tabs analyze, review, and validate the same assessment.

Tab	Purpose
Assessment	Complete the OASIS-E with AI guidance (the default view).
Analyze	Deep-dive accuracy scoring, compliance gaps, and clinical-pathway recommendations.
Review & Approve	Queue of completed assessments awaiting clinician sign-off.
Clinical	Clinician quality check — validates answers against documented diagnoses and symptoms.
Quality & Documentation	Compliance validation, missing fields, and documentation gaps.

i Some tabs are for administrators

Revenue, Analytics, and Audit tabs present financial and agency-wide data and appear for facility administrators. Clinicians work primarily in Assessment, Analyze, Review, Clinical, and Quality.

7 Incident Reporting

When a safety event happens — a fall, a medication error, an injury — report it in PennSync so it reaches the right people and any required state filing is handled.

WHO CAN USE THIS

NURSE

FACILITY ADMIN

GO TO

Sidebar

Patient Care

Incidents

REPORT IT RIGHT AWAY

Reporting a safety event

1 Open Incidents

Choose Incidents from the Patient Care section, then the Report tab.

2 Select the patient

Pick the involved patient from your active list.

3 Classify the event

Choose the event type and severity, then describe what happened.

4 Submit

PennSync time-stamps the report, applies AI severity scoring, and automatically flags events that may be state-reportable.

The **Recent Reports** tab lists what you've submitted with status badges (new, pending review, resolved, state-reported) so you can track each one to closure.



Report promptly and factually

Document objective facts (what, when, where, who was present) as soon as it's safe to do so. Your administrator reviews and, where required, files the incident with the state.

8 Patient Education

Generate personalized, easy-to-understand education for your patients — then confirm understanding with teach-back and track what you've sent.

WHO CAN USE THIS

NURSE

FACILITY ADMIN

GO TO

Sidebar

Patient Care

Patient Education

PERSONALIZED IN SECONDS

Creating a handout

1 Choose a topic

Pick from common conditions — CHF, COPD, oxygen therapy, diabetes, hypertension, stroke recovery, wound care, infection prevention, medication management, fall prevention, palliative care, pain management, and more.

2 Personalize with AI

PennSync tailors the handout to the patient's history and adjusts the reading level for clear comprehension.

3 Style it

Set font size and colors, choose which sections to include, and add the patient's name and any custom notes.

4 Preview & deliver

Preview, then download as a PDF to print or email it directly to the patient or family.

CONFIRM UNDERSTANDING

Teach-back & tracking

Use the **Teach-Back** tab to document a teach-back session and verify the patient understood their instructions. The **Tracking** tab shows which handouts you've sent, delivery confirmation, and engagement.



Best practice: pair education with teach-back

Teaching plus a documented teach-back is strong evidence of skilled care and supports Medicare compliance. Generate the handout, teach from it, then record the teach-back in the same place.

9

Documenting a Visit

Documentation is where PennSync saves you the most time. Everything lives in the Clinical Notes hub, where you choose the approach that fits the moment.

WHO CAN USE THIS

NURSE

FACILITY ADMIN

GO TO

Sidebar

Documentation

Clinical Notes

PICK YOUR STYLE

Two ways to document

Smart Note — type

Jot a few rough observations and let AI expand them into a complete, compliant, skilled note.

Visit Scribe — speak

Record or dictate the visit out loud; PennSync transcribes it and turns it into a compliant note.

FASTEST FOR TYPING

Smart Note (typed)

Smart Note turns a few quick observations into a complete, compliant note in five steps:

1

Select patient

AI personalizes to their diagnoses, meds, and history.

2

Enter vitals

Structured vitals flow to the chart and trends.

3

Write observations

Plain language and bullet points are fine.

4

AI checks & polishes

Compliance is verified; skilled language is added.

5

Review & save

Edit if needed; the visit and audit are created.

Clinical Notes — Smart Note

Patient 1

Vitals 2

Your observations 3

AI compliance & polish 4

Save note 5

FIGURE The Smart Note screen — the numbered areas match the walkthrough below.

- 1 Select the patient — AI uses their record to personalize the note.
- 2 Enter vital signs in the structured form.
- 3 Type your observations in plain language.
- 4 AI flags any compliance issues and rewrites your text into a skilled note.
- 5 Review and Save — the visit and compliance audit are created automatically.

STEP BY STEP

- 1 Choose Smart Note**
 In Clinical Notes, select Smart Note. Always select the patient first.
- 2 Capture vitals**
 Enter vital signs (temperature, blood pressure, heart rate, respiratory rate, O₂, pain) in the structured form so they reach the chart and trends.
- 3 Write your observations**
 Type rough notes in plain language — bullet points are fine.
- 4 Let AI check & polish**
 PennSync flags compliance issues (Home Health or Hospice rules) and rewrites your notes into professional, skilled documentation with medical-necessity and homebound language.

5 Review, edit & save

Confirm the note reads accurately, make any edits, and save. The visit record and compliance audit are created automatically.

★ Always select the patient first

Selecting the patient lets AI personalize the note using their diagnoses, medications, and history. The more you document for a patient, the better the suggestions get.

HANDS-FREE

Visit Scribe (spoken)

Visit Scribe offers two ways to capture a visit by voice:

Mode	How it works
Record / Upload	Record the visit audio in your browser or upload a recording. Play it back, then transcribe it to text.
Live Dictation	Dictate in real time and watch the transcription appear as you speak; pause, resume, and edit.

Either way, PennSync selects the patient and visit type, captures vitals, transcribes your words, and runs the result through the same compliance review and polishing as a typed Smart Note before saving to the chart.

★ Save 10–15 minutes per visit

Speaking your note in Visit Scribe is often much faster than typing. Narrate the visit naturally — PennSync handles structure and skilled language for you.

REUSABLE TEXT, INSTANTLY

Quick phrases (type "/")

Quick phrases expand a short trigger into full, Medicare-compliant narrative right inside your note — wound-care language, diabetic education, homebound status, and anything you save yourself.

1 Trigger the picker

In the observations box, type / to open the Quick Phrases picker, type a saved **.shortcut** code (for example **.diabeticedu**), or tap the **Quick Phrase** button in the header. Everyday clinical shorthand (120/80, c/o, N/V) never triggers it by accident.

2 Pick a phrase

Use the arrow keys and Enter (or tap) to choose. Badges show each phrase's scope: **Patient** (bound to the selected patient), **AI** (personalized with patient details), or **Agency** (shared agency-wide).

3 Review the inserted text

The full expansion is inserted at your cursor. It's treated as your own draft — it still flows through the same compliance review before you save.

Create and manage your phrases in the **Clinical Library** (Learning & Resources ► Library). When creating a phrase you can **bind it to a specific patient** — for example, that patient's exact wound-care orders. A patient-bound phrase appears and expands only while you're charting that patient, so it can never land in another patient's note.



Quick phrases need no round-trip

The built-in starter phrases expand instantly on the device, so "/" stays fast even on a weak connection.

YOUR AGENCY'S RULES, CHECKED LIVE

Facility documentation requirements

Your administrator can define agency documentation rules — for example, *oxygen patients need an SpO₂ reading, diabetic patients need a blood sugar, any wound needs measurements*. When the selected patient matches a rule, a **Facility Documentation Requirements** panel appears in Smart Note showing what this note must include.

- Each requirement starts amber and flips to a struck-through green check the moment you document it — the panel counts down live ("2 to document" → "All requirements met").
- While you're drafting (Step 1), unmet requirements are a gentle reminder — you can always continue to review.
- On the final note (Step 2), an unmet **critical** requirement blocks Save until you either add the missing detail or explicitly acknowledge saving without it. Acknowledged overrides are recorded for your agency's audit trail.



Where the rules come from

Requirements are written by your facility administrator, often from state-survey findings or agency policy. If a requirement seems wrong for a patient, document your clinical reasoning and let your administrator know.

CLOSE THE LOOP

Vitals & closing a scheduled visit

When you document from a scheduled or overdue visit (for example, via a “Document this visit” link on the patient record or a compliance alert), PennSync loads that visit, pre-selects the patient and visit type, and **completes the existing visit on save** — so you’re not left with a duplicate and any related alert clears.



Vitals travel with the note

Vitals you enter on a note are saved to the visit, so they appear on the chart, in the vitals trend, and in critical-vitals escalation. They reset when you switch patients, so one patient’s readings never land on another’s chart.

10

Communication

PennSync keeps every conversation — with teammates, patients, and physician offices — inside the platform, and protects your personal number while doing it.

WHO CAN USE THIS

NURSE

FACILITY ADMIN

TEAM MESSAGING

Messages

GO TO

Sidebar

Communication

Messages

Send secure internal messages to teammates, set a priority (Urgent, High, or Normal), and link a message to a specific patient for clean care coordination and handoffs. Filter your inbox by priority or read status; a badge shows unread messages.

- **Search your inbox** by subject, sender, or message text to find a patient's thread in seconds instead of scrolling.
- **Escalate a single reply** — when something in a routine thread turns urgent, flip the reply's urgent toggle to raise just that reply above the thread's normal priority.
- **Your words are safe** — if a send fails on flaky cellular, your typed message is preserved so you can retry, not retype.

CALLS & TEXTS, PROTECTED

Phone Center

GO TO

Sidebar

Communication

Phone Center

The Phone Center works like a phone app, with tabs for:

Tab	What it does
Texts	SMS conversations with patients, threaded by person with patient context (name, MRN, diagnosis).
Recents	Inbound and outbound call history with duration, time, and recordings where available.
Callbacks	A queue of patients waiting to hear back, with one-tap calling.
Scheduled	Text messages queued to send later; edit or cancel any time.
Duty Status	Toggle on/off duty; off-duty callers get an away message.

Your personal number stays private

All calls and texts route through a masked work number. Patients never see your personal cell, and your communication history stays in PennSync.

STILL ESSENTIAL IN HEALTHCARE

Fax

GO TO [Sidebar](#) ▶ [Communication](#) ▶ [Fax](#)

Send a fax straight from your phone or computer:

- 1 Choose a source**
Snap a photo with your camera, upload a file, or select a patient document or template.
- 2 Add the recipient**
Enter a fax number or pick from your fax contacts (physician offices, facilities).
- 3 Send & track**
PennSync can add a professional cover page, sends securely, and tracks delivery status.

Use **Batch** to send to several recipients at once, and the **Contacts**, **History**, and **Logs** tabs to manage your address book and confirm delivery.

YOUR REFERRAL NETWORK

Providers directory

GO TO [Sidebar](#) ▶ [Communication](#) ▶ [Providers](#)

Look up physicians and provider offices with their phone, fax, email, address, and specialty. Add or update entries so contact details stay current for the whole team.

VIRTUAL VISITS

Telehealth

GO TO **Sidebar** ▶ **Communication** ▶ **Telehealth**

- 1 Schedule a session**
Choose the patient, visit type, and date/time.
- 2 Send the join link**
Text the patient a secure link — they join from any browser, no app or login required.
- 3 Run the visit**
Use standard controls (mute, camera on/off) and view vitals live during the call.
- 4 Document**
Capture findings and generate a note right from the session.

★ **Telehealth for quick check-ins**

Virtual visits are ideal for medication reviews, symptom checks, and follow-ups — saving a drive while keeping eyes on your patient.

11

Learning & Resources

Grow your skills and keep certifications current — and reach trusted clinical and Medicare references whenever you need them.

WHO CAN USE THIS

NURSE

FACILITY ADMIN

YOUR TRAINING HOME

The Learning Center

GO TO

Sidebar

▶

Learning & Resources

▶

Learning Center

The Learning Center brings your training together as tabs:

Area	What it's for
Active Courses & Catalog	Browse, enroll in, and resume courses; track progress on each.
Learning Plans	Assigned learning paths with due dates and completion badges.
Competencies & Skill Gaps	See your competencies by role and where to focus next.
Certificates & Renewals	Download certificates and stay ahead of expirations (export renewals to your calendar).
In-Services & Annual Education	Attend in-services and complete annual mandatory education.
Transcripts	Your complete learning record and CEUs, exportable as a PDF.

Open a course in the **Course Player** for video lessons, quizzes, and a certificate on completion. Nurses can also use the **Nurse Training Hub** for role-specific, AI-personalized training.

★

Never miss a renewal

Check the Renewals tab monthly and export it to your calendar so licenses and certifications never lapse.

ANSWERS ON DEMAND

Reference libraries

GO TO

Sidebar

▶

Learning & Resources

▶

Library

Resource Library

Agency reference materials, guidelines, procedures, and policies.

Clinical Library

Disease-state information, treatment protocols, medication and lab references.

Medicare Guidelines

CMS / Medicare home-health policy, OASIS guidance, and documentation requirements.

12 Personal Tools & Settings

Tune PennSync to you: control notifications, request time off, and check on-call coverage.

WHO CAN USE THIS

NURSE

FACILITY ADMIN

MAKE IT YOURS

Settings & notifications

GO TO

Sidebar

Tools

Settings

In Settings, update your profile and care scope, manage your credentials, and set AI preferences. From **Notification Settings**, choose which alerts you receive (messages, SMS, clinical alerts, approvals), set a quiet/do-not-disturb window, and pick email-digest options.

PLAN AHEAD

Time Off

GO TO

Sidebar

Tools

Time Off

1

Create a request

Choose your dates and request type (vacation, sick, PTO), add a note, and submit.

2

Track it

See pending and approved requests, and cancel a request if plans change.

i

Managers get more

If you manage a team, additional tabs let you approve requests and view a team calendar and coverage — see the administrator manual.

KNOW WHO'S COVERING

On-Call Schedule

GO TO

Sidebar

Tools

On-Call

View the on-call calendar for holiday and overnight coverage so you always know who's on. Editing the schedule is reserved for administrators.

13 Timesheets & Getting Paid

Every staff member submits a timesheet for each pay period. PennSync tracks your hours, visit points, PTO, and mileage, routes the sheet to your approver, and feeds approved timesheets straight into payroll.

WHO CAN USE THIS

NURSE

FACILITY ADMIN

GO TO

Sidebar

Tools

Timesheets

THE RHYTHM

Pay periods, deadlines & paydays

- **Pay periods are biweekly** — two full weeks, Sunday through Saturday. The pay-period dropdown lists each scheduled period (e.g. "Jun 14 – Jun 27, 2026").
- **Timesheets are due before noon (12:00 PM) on the Monday** after the period ends. Past the deadline, the form flags the period **Past due** in red.
- **Payday is normally the Friday after the period ends.** If that Friday is a bank holiday, payday moves to the day before (Thursday). Occasionally payroll confirms a different date for a specific period — when that happens, the adjusted date is what the form shows.



No math required

When you pick a pay period, the form shows its exact **Due** date/time and **Payday** right below the dropdown — no need to memorize the schedule. The payday shown there is the authoritative one, including any payroll-confirmed adjustments.

A FEW MINUTES, TWICE A MONTH

Submitting your timesheet

1

Open My Timesheet

In Timesheets, the My Timesheet tab shows a New Timesheet form. Pick your pay period.

2

Check your service line

A read-only chip shows how you're paid — **Home Health** (paid by points + hourly for field staff, or hourly) or **Hospice** (hourly). Your administrator sets this; if it looks wrong, tell them before submitting.

3 Choose an entry mode

Bulk (period total) enters one total for the whole period; **Daily entry** gives you a row per day with automatic totals.

4 Enter visits & hours

Home-health field staff paid by points enter visit counts — SOC, ROC, Recert, Routine Visit, Discharge — with each type's point value shown and a live total. Everyone enters Regular, Overtime, Holiday, and On-Call hours; hospice staff also enter On-Call Visits.

5 Confirm PTO & reimbursements

Approved Time Off overlapping the period is carried in automatically (a green "+N hrs from approved PTO (auto-added)" badge) — enter only *additional* PTO hours. Add your miles and any other reimbursement; a standing phone reimbursement is auto-added if your administrator has set one.

6 Submit

Pick your approver (or leave it unset to route to the administrators), add optional notes, then **Save draft** or **Submit for approval**. Your approver is notified automatically.

FROM SUBMITTED TO PAID

Tracking, edits & approval

The **My Timesheets** list shows each sheet's period, totals, and status:

Status	What it means
Draft	Saved but not submitted — keep editing any time.
Submitted	Waiting for your approver's review.
Approved	Locked and included in the payroll export for that period.
Rejected	Returned for changes — the reviewer's note tells you what to fix. Edit and resubmit.

! Approved timesheets are locked

Once approved, a timesheet can no longer be edited — and you can't submit a second one for the same pay period. If something changed after approval, ask your approver or administrator to reopen it. You can edit only **Draft** and **Rejected** sheets; resubmitting clears the previous review and notifies your approver again.



Hours and points, not dollars

PennSync records what you worked — hours, visit points, miles, and reimbursements. Pay rates and wage amounts are handled by your agency's accountant, outside the app.

14

Tips & Best Practices

A handful of habits used by PennSync's most efficient clinicians.



Always select your patient in Smart Notes

AI personalizes documentation from the patient's history — selecting them first makes every suggestion sharper.



Use voice for long visits

Visit Scribe can save 10–15 minutes per visit versus typing. Narrate naturally and let AI structure the note.



Favorite your frequent patients

Star the patients you see most for instant access from your roster.



Build a template library

Create quick phrases in the Clinical Library for common documentation (wound care, diabetic teaching), then expand them anywhere by typing / in a note. Bind a phrase to a specific patient for their exact orders.



Submit timesheets before the Monday deadline

Timesheets are due before noon on the Monday after each pay period ends. Submitting on Friday after your last visit keeps payroll smooth and avoids the "Past due" flag.



Review your compliance weekly

Glance at your documentation quality regularly and clear any flagged notes to keep your compliance rate high.

**Always review AI output**

AI drafts documentation — you own it. Read every note before saving; edit anything that isn't exactly right. PennSync learns from your corrections.

15

Frequently Asked Questions

Quick answers to the questions clinicians ask most.

How do I document a visit using my voice?

Open Clinical Notes, choose Visit Scribe, and either record/upload audio or use Live Dictation. PennSync transcribes your words and generates a Medicare-compliant note for you to review and save.

Why should I always select a patient in Smart Notes?

Selecting a patient lets AI personalize documentation using their specific diagnoses, medications, and history. The more you document for a patient, the better the AI recommendations become.

How does AI enhance my clinical notes?

It expands your observations into skilled nursing language, adds medical-necessity justification, includes homebound documentation, and checks Medicare compliance — all while preserving your clinical intent.

What if AI generates something incorrect?

Always review AI-generated content. Edit it directly, regenerate, or add your own text. PennSync learns from your corrections over time.

How do I send a fax from my phone?

In Fax, use the camera to capture your document, add the recipient number, and send. PennSync can generate a professional cover page automatically.

Can I create custom documentation templates?

Yes. Use the Clinical Library to create quick phrases that expand into full documentation, including patient-specific variables. You can bind a phrase to one specific patient so it only appears while charting them.

How do I use a quick phrase while writing a note?

Type "/" in the observations box to open the Quick Phrases picker, type a saved ".shortcut" code, or tap the Quick Phrase button. The expanded text is inserted at your cursor and still goes through compliance review before you save.

Why is Save blocked by a "facility documentation requirement"?

Your administrator has defined a critical documentation rule that applies to this patient (for example, an SpO₂ reading for a patient on oxygen). Add the missing detail — the checklist clears automatically — or check the acknowledgment box to save without it; acknowledged overrides are recorded.

When is my timesheet due, and when is payday?

Pay periods are biweekly (Sunday through Saturday). Timesheets are due before noon on the Monday after the period ends, and payday is normally the Friday after the period ends — moved to Thursday when that Friday is a bank holiday, and occasionally adjusted for a specific period when payroll confirms it. The timesheet form shows the authoritative due date and payday for the period you pick.

What is the AI-content responsibility agreement I saw at sign-in?

A one-time acknowledgment (re-shown only if the wording changes) that AI-generated content may contain errors and that you are responsible for reviewing and approving anything you submit. Your acceptance is recorded with your name, the date, and the agreement version.

What does the "AI-generated — verify before clinical use" line mean?

It marks text that AI drafted (patient summaries, insights, incident narratives, and similar), often with a generated-at time. Treat it as a draft: read it, correct it, and only then rely on it or save it.

How do OASIS suggestions work?

AI analyzes patient history, recent notes, and diagnoses to suggest appropriate OASIS responses, highlight compliance risks, and optimize for PDGM case mix. You confirm every answer.

What happens to a flagged compliance issue?

Flagged notes appear where you can review them, apply AI suggestions to fix the issue, and re-save. PennSync tracks your improvement over time.

A feature in this manual isn't in my sidebar — why?

Some tools are limited to facility administrators. If you don't see it, your role doesn't include it. Contact your administrator if you believe you need access.

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Glossary

Common terms you'll see throughout PennSync.

Care scope	Whether you (or a patient) are set to Home Health, Hospice, or Both. It tailors dashboards, templates, and compliance checks.
OASIS / OASIS-E	The standardized CMS assessment (Outcome and Assessment Information Set) completed at key points in a home-health episode. OASIS-E is the current version.
PDGM	Patient-Driven Groupings Model — how Medicare determines home-health payment from diagnoses, timing, and functional status (the "case mix").
Case mix	The weighting that reflects a patient's clinical and functional complexity, which drives PDGM reimbursement.
HHA	Home Health Agency.
Homebound	A Medicare eligibility criterion: leaving home requires considerable effort. Documentation must support homebound status for skilled home-health coverage.
Skilled documentation	Notes written in professional clinical language that show medical necessity and the skilled nature of the care provided.
Quick phrase	A saved trigger (opened with "/" or a ".shortcut" code) that expands into full documentation text. A phrase can be bound to one specific patient.
Facility documentation rule	An agency-defined charting requirement (e.g. SpO ₂ for oxygen patients) checked live in Smart Note; critical rules must be documented or explicitly acknowledged before saving.
Pay period	The biweekly Sunday-through-Saturday window a timesheet covers. Timesheets are due by noon the following Monday; payday is normally the Friday after the period ends (Thursday when that Friday is a bank holiday), with any payroll-confirmed adjustment shown on the timesheet form.

Visit points	Units of work credited per visit type (SOC, ROC, Recert, Routine, Discharge) for home-health field staff paid by the point. Point values are set by your administrator; no dollar amounts are stored in PennSync.
Smart Note	PennSync’s typed documentation tool that turns brief observations into a complete, compliant note with AI.
Visit Scribe	PennSync’s voice documentation tool that records or dictates a visit and transcribes it into a compliant note.
Teach-back	A method of confirming patient understanding by having them restate instructions in their own words.
Telehealth	A secure video visit with a patient conducted through PennSync.

17

Getting Help & Support

Help is always close by — inside the app and from your team.

In-app Help

Open Help (Tools → Help) for quick-start guidance, feature overviews, a searchable FAQ, and this manual as a PDF download.

User Guides

Tools → Help → User Guides offers focused, downloadable guides for specific workflows.

Your administrator

For access, account, or agency-specific questions, contact your facility administrator.

Announcements

Watch your Dashboard for announcements about new features and training.



Print this manual for the workstation

Download the PDF from Help and keep a printed copy at shared workstations for quick reference during daily workflows.

GO TO

Sidebar



Tools



Help